

Zaur Kapanadze

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Education

- 2026 (expected) **Ph.D.**, *Texas Tech University*, Department of Political Science
Committee: Frank Thames (Chair), Bilyana Petrova, Dennis Patterson, and Kevin Grier
Fields: Comparative Politics and American Politics with a minor in Methods
- May 2023 **M.A.**, *Texas Tech University*, Department of Political Science
- December 2020 **B.A.**, *Texas Tech University*, Major in Political Science with a minor in Russian Language and Area Studies, Cum Laude

Research Interests

Business and Politics, Comparative Politics, Democratization, Electoral Systems, Oligarchs, Post-Communist Politics, Political Economy, and Legislative Behavior

Research

Journal Articles

Zaur Kapanadze. n.d. Oligarchs and Regional Political Machines: Patronage and Elections in the Republic of Georgia. (Accepted at *Europe-Asia Studies*).

Selected Works in Progress

Frank C. Thames and Zaur Kapanadze. Explaining Electoral Reform in the Georgian Parliament.

Zaur Kapanadze. Businessman Deputies and Executive Votes: Government Appointment in the Georgian Parliament.

Zaur Kapanadze. Are Equalizing Transfers Really Equalizing? Oligarchs and Regional Development in Georgia.

Zaur Kapanadze. Patronage and National Executive: Budget Policy and Oligarchic Interests in the Georgian Parliament.

Zaur Kapanadze. Mandate Divide, Ideology, and Gender Quotas in the 9th and 10th Georgian Parliament.

Conference Papers

Zaur Kapanadze. Patronage and National Executive: Budget Policy and Oligarchic Interests in the Georgian Parliament. Chicago, IL, April 2026. Midwestern Political Science Association. (Scheduled)

Zaur Kapanadze. Patronage, Oligarchic Interests and Budget Policy in the Georgian Parliament. Washington, DC, November 2025. Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies.

Zaur Kapanadze. Are Equalizing Transfers Really Equalizing? Oligarchs and Regional Development in the Republic of Georgia. Boston, MA, 2024. Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies.

Zaur Kapanadze. Oligarchs and Allocation of Equalizing Transfers in the Republic of Georgia. Philadelphia, PA, 2024. American Political Science Association.

Zaur Kapanadze. The Influence of Oligarchic Networks and Regional Political Machines on Electoral Politics: The Case of Georgian Municipal Election (2010-2021). Philadelphia, PA, 2023. Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies.

Zaur Kapanadze. The Influence of Oligarchs and Regional Political Machines on Georgian Elections. Los Angeles, CA, 2023. American Political Science Association.

Workshops and Poster Presentations

Zaur Kapanadze. Patronage and National Executive: Budget Policy and Oligarchic Interests in the Georgian Parliament (Poster). Houston, TX 2026. Texas Comparative Politics Circle. (Scheduled)

Zaur Kapanadze. Are Equalizing Transfers Really Equalizing? Oligarchs and Regional Development in the Republic of Georgia (Poster). Austin, TX, 2025. Texas Comparative Politics Circle.

Zaur Kapanadze. Are Equalizing Transfers Really Equalizing? Oligarchs and Regional Development in the Republic of Georgia. Chicago, IL, 2025. Politics and Political Economy of Eurasia Workshop.

Zaur Kapanadze. Mandate Divide, Ideology, and Gender Quotas in the 9th Convocation of the Georgia Parliament (Poster). Denton, TX, 2024. Texas Comparative Politics Circle.

Zaur Kapanadze. The Political-Economy of CSTO Membership (Poster). Lubbock, TX, 2023. Texas Comparative Politics Circle.

Teaching Experience

Primary Instructor

POLS 1301 American Government (Fall 2024)

POLS 2371 Comparative Politics (Spring 2026 scheduled)

Teaching Assistant

POLS 3372 Post-Communist Politics (Fall 2021, 2022, and 2023)

POLS 3325 Political Parties (Spring 2022)

POLS 2371 Comparative Politics (Summer 2022 and 2023, and Fall 2022 and 2025)

POLS 3302 Comparative Welfare State (Spring 2023)

POLS 3300 American Electoral Development (Spring 2024)

POLS 3300 Politics of Income Inequality (Spring 2024)

POLS 3323 Congress (Summer 2025)

POLS 3302 Social Policy Around the World (Fall 2025)

Course Administrator

POLS 1301 American Government (all online sections for Spring 2025)

POLS 2306 Texas Politics and Topics (all online sections for Spring 2025)

Grader

POLS 2306 Texas Politics and Topics (Summer 2022, Fall 2023, and Spring 2025)
POLS 1301 American Government (Spring 2023)

Grants and Awards

- 2025-2026 Dissertation Research Grant. Association for Slavic, East European, and Eurasian Studies. \$5,000.
- 2024-2025 Kent Presson Scholarship. Texas Tech University, Department of Political Science. \$1,000.
- 2025 Summer Research Support for Research Purposes. Texas Tech University, Department of Political Science. \$3,400.
- 2025 Summer Thesis/Dissertation Research Award. Texas Tech University, Graduate School. \$2,300.
- 2024 Summer Research Support for Research Purposes. Texas Tech University, Department of Political Science. \$4,000.
- 2023-2024 William E. Oden Endowed Scholarship. Texas Tech University, Department of Political Science. \$1,000.
- 2022-2023 Kent Presson Scholarship. Texas Tech University, Department of Political Science. \$1,200.
- 2021-2022 William E. Oden Endowed Scholarship. Texas Tech University, Department of Political Science. \$702.

Fieldwork

Georgia (May - August 2024)
Georgia (May - July 2025)

Skills and Languages

Languages

Georgian (native), English (fluent), Russian (fluent), and French (intermediate)

Software

Stata, R, Python, and L^AT_EX

Methods Training

OLS, MLE, causal inference, game theory, multilevel models, time series